

Bedtime Procrastination Related to Lifestyle and Psychological Factors among Chinese College Students



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Introduction

- Background:** Bedtime procrastination, characterized by voluntarily delaying going to bed despite intending to sleep, has emerged as a significant factor contributing to poor sleep quality among Chinese college students (Ma et al., 2020). Chronic sleep deprivation resulting from bedtime procrastination has been associated with elevated levels of stress, anxiety, depression, and impaired cognitive functioning.
- Statement of the Problem:** This study aims to explore the lifestyle and psychological predictors of bedtime procrastination among Chinese college students.
- Hypothesis 1:** A healthy lifestyle (e.g. early chronotype, high level of physical activity, and low level of social media use) will be negatively associated with bedtime procrastination.
- Hypothesis 2:** Higher levels of perceived academic stress and depression will be positively associated with bedtime procrastination.

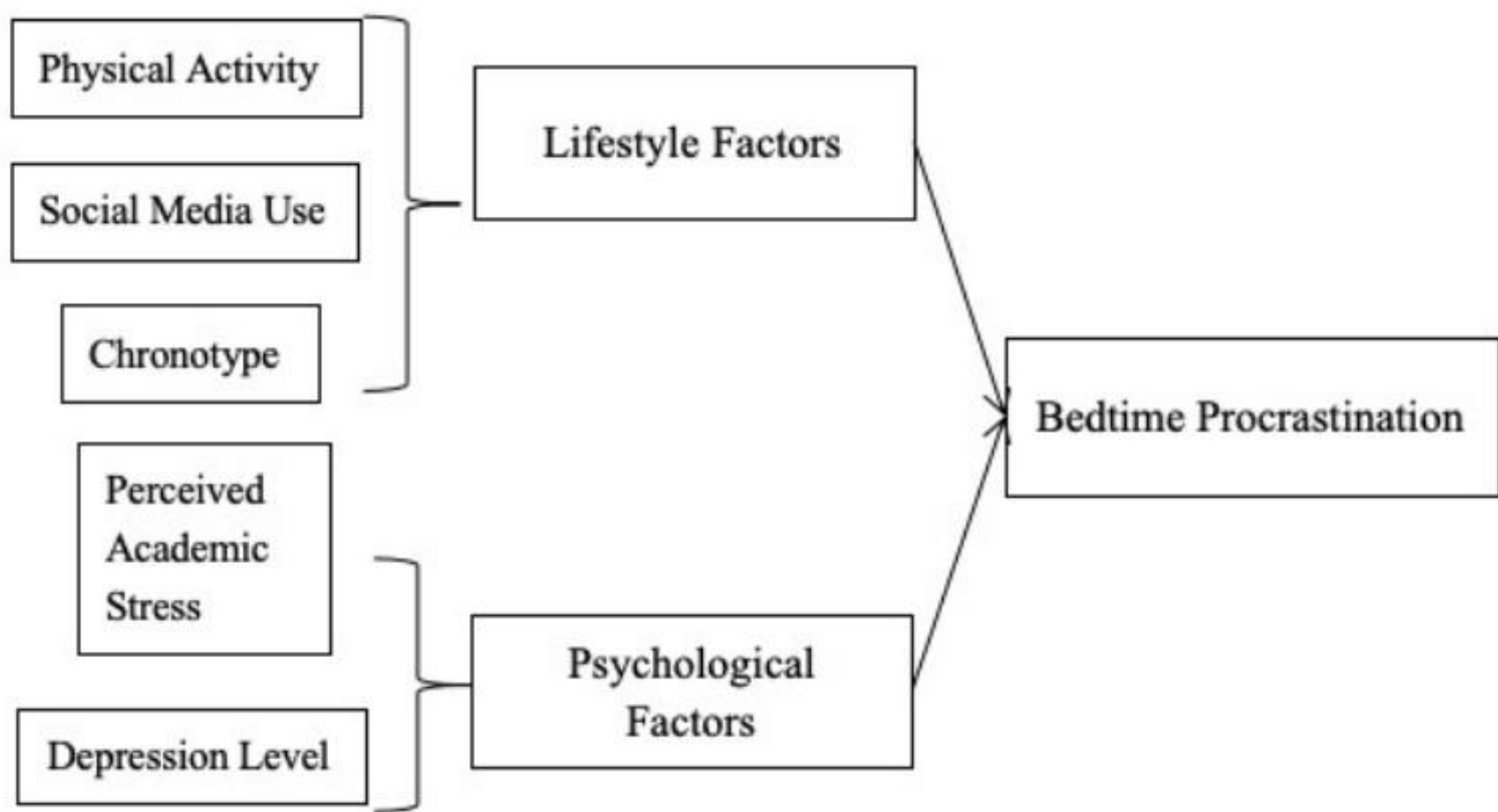


Figure 1. Conceptual Framework

Results

Table 1 Descriptive statistics for all variables (N= 190)

	N (%)	M (± SD)
Age		21.05 (2.43)
18-20	74 (39.00)	--
21-23	104 (54.70)	--
Gender		
Female	167 (87.90)	--
Male	23 (12.10)	--
Bedtime Procrastination Behavior(BPS total)	--	29.94 (6.47)
Chronotype (rMEQ)	--	11.96 (3.96)
Physical Activity(PAQ-AD)	--	1.76 (.67)
Social Media Addiction(BSMAS)	--	18.47 (5.05)
Academic Stress(PAS)	--	3.56 (.97)
Depressive Symptoms (PHQ)	--	9.28 (5.53)

Table 2 Correlation analysis coefficients (N= 190)

	1	2	3	4	5	6
1 Bedtime Procrastination Behavior(BPS total)	1					
2 Chronotype (rMEQ)	-.45**	1				
3 Physical Activity(PAQ-AD)	-.20**	.28**	1			
4 Social Media Addiction(BSMAS)	.26**	-.17*	-.03	1		
5 Academic Stress(PAS)	.26**	-.07	-.16*	.15*	1	
6 Depressive Symptoms (PHQ)	.36**	-.21**	-.02	.28**	.40**	1

Notes. * $p \leq 0.05$; ** $p \leq 0.01$; *** $p \leq 0.001$

Table 3 Regression - Bootstrapped coefficients with BPS total score as outcome

	B	Bootstrap Std. Error	p value (2-tailed)	95% Confidence Interval	
				Lower	Upper
(Constant)	30.09	2.65	.00	24.87	35.31
Chronotype (rMEQ)-X1	-.59	.11	.01	-.81	-.38
Physical Activity(PAQ-AD)	-.64	.63	.31	-1.89	.61
Social Media Addiction(BSMAS)	.15	.08	.06	-.01	.32
Academic Stress(PAS)	.86	.46	.06	-.03	1.76
Depressive Symptoms (PHQ)-X2	.23	.08	.01	.07	.39

- Specifically, more depressive symptoms (higher scores on PHQ) were associated with higher level of bedtime procrastination behavior (higher BPS scores). A later chronotype was associated with high level of bedtime procrastination behavior.

Methods and Data Analysis

- Participants:** A sample of 190 Chinese students located in China.
- Materials:** Except for participants' socio-demographic variables, such as age, gender, we also collected questionnaire data from BPS-9, rMEQ, PAQ-AD-8, BSMAS-6, PAS-1, PHQ-9.
- Design:** This is a quantitative research. The independent variables are lifestyle and psychological factors, while the dependent variable is subjective bedtime procrastination behavior.
- Procedure:** All questionnaires were collected online.
- Data analysis:** SPSS 26.0 software was performed.

Conclusion and Discussion

- This study examined bedtime procrastination behavior (BPP) and its relationship with lifestyle and psychological factors.
- Regression analysis identified chronotype and depressive symptoms as key predictors of BPP. The findings suggest that reducing social media use and developing interventions tailored to individual chronotypes may help lower academic stress and depression, thereby improving sleep habits.
- Despite limitations such as a small sample size, the study provides useful insights for future research aimed at improving student well-being.

References

Ma, X., Zhu, L., Guo, J., Zhao, Y., Fu, Y., & Mu, L. (2021). Reliability and validity of the Bedtime Procrastination Scale among Chinese college students. *Chin J Clin Psychol*, 29(4), 717-20. <https://doi.org/10.16128/j.cnki.1005-3611.2021.04.011>.

Bernecker, K., & Job, V. (2020). Too exhausted to go to bed: Implicit theories about willpower and stress predict bedtime procrastination. *British Journal of Psychology*, 111(1), 126-147. <https://doi.org/10.1111/bjop.12382>

